Balanced plate recap

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 1 Thursday 7 January 2027 P1 Year A

A balanced eating pattern uses a variety of food groups. The meal you design is one part of what someone eats over time.

Food group	Useful choice	Example in our meal
Vegetables and fruit	Aim for plenty and a variety over the day.	Carrot, cabbage and apple
Starchy foods	Choose wholegrain or higher-fibre options when suitable.	Wholemeal wrap
Protein foods	Beans, lentils, eggs, fish or meat are examples.	Ready-to-eat beans
Dairy foods or alternatives	Choose an unsweetened, calcium-fortified alternative where needed.	Plain yoghurt
Oils and spreads	Use unsaturated types in small amounts when used.	No added oil is needed for this cold dish

The two largest groups in a balanced eating pattern are vegetables and fruit, and starchy foods. Include protein foods and dairy or suitable alternatives. Use small amounts of oils and spreads. Balance is built across the day or week; every meal does not need exact plate sections. Choose water as a drink. No calorie counting, weight talk or food judgement is needed.

The quantities in this pack are classroom planning examples. Appetite and individual needs vary. These examples do not set a diet or a nutritional target for each pupil.